When the page handler has called out to the application model that contains the application business logic, it's time to generate a response. A *view model* captures the details necessary for the view to generate a response.

**DEFINITION** A *view model* in the MVC pattern is all the data required by the view to render a UI. It's typically some transformation of the data contained in the application model, plus extra information required to render the page, such as the page's title.

The term *view model* is used extensively in ASP.NET Core MVC, where it typically refers to a single object that is passed to the Razor view to render. With Razor Pages, however, the Razor view can access the Razor Page's page model class directly. Therefore, the Razor Page `PageModel` typically acts as the view model in Razor Pages, with the data required by the Razor view exposed via properties, as you saw in listing 13.5.

**NOTE** Razor Pages use the `PageModel` class itself as the view model for the Razor view by exposing the required data as properties.

The Razor view uses the data exposed in the page model to generate the final HTML response. Finally, this data is sent back through the middleware pipeline and out to the user's browser, as shown in figure 13.11.